

Animals

Some of the earliest known art depicts animals, either carved or painted on cave walls, and animals continue to be featured in art in many different cultures, as symbols, mythical creatures, gods or as themselves. Renaissance portraits of ladies or children often include animals such as a pet squirrel or dog, and by the 18th century, portraits of a favourite horse or dog, prize livestock or wildlife were commissioned by the wealthy.

In Britain, George Stubbs specialized in lifelike paintings of horses and later Edwin Henry Landseer (1802–73), the favourite artist of Queen Victoria, became best known for his lion sculptures in London's Trafalgar Square. Edgar Degas was once as famous for his energetic horse paintings and later sculptures as for his dancers, while monkeys appeared symbolically in paintings by Georges Seurat and Frida Kahlo. Franz Marc, a German Expressionist, perceived animals to be on a higher plane than humans, and painted many in bright, unnatural colours and fragmented compositions.



Landseer, *Monarch of the Glen*, 1851